

Spectrea Brand Guide

The complete brand system for Spectrea — a composable intelligence platform that turns scattered information into compounding intelligence.



Tagline: We connect the dots. **Category:** Composable intelligence platform. **Pronunciation:** /spek-TREE-uh/ (a coinage from *spectrum* — Latin, from *specere*, "to look"; the full range — with a second reading: *revealing*).

Version: 2.5.8 (2026-08-08). Canonical data: `src/data/brand.ts` — this guide is a hybrid mirror: prose is hand-written; fenced data blocks are generated from `canon ( npm run generate:guide )`.

Strategic claim: Spectrea is the spectrum of clarity. Everything you know, in one living view — alive with possibility, yours to keep. See it whole. Trust what you see. Build on what you find.

1. Brand Foundation

Why we exist

We live in an information age that's paradoxically making us less informed — more data, less truth; more tools, fewer insights; more noise, less action. Spectrea exists to close the gap between having information, truly understanding it, and being able to build on it.

Mission

To make knowledge trustworthy, connected, and actionable — empowering people to build on what came before, so that every insight becomes the foundation for what comes next.

Vision

A world where anyone can see the full spectrum of what's known, trust what they see, and build on it — where understanding compounds across every boundary that used to contain it.

Positioning

- **For:** Anyone who works with knowledge.
- **Category:** Composable intelligence platform.

- **Promise:** Turns scattered information into compounding intelligence.
- **Full-shape claim (vision §1, adopted 2026-07-19):** Compounding collective intelligence — compounding intelligence is the temporal property (each cycle sharpens the next), collective intelligence the cardinality property (the org acts as one); Spectrea's target is both together. Internal north-star and depth-surface language (docs, vision, architecture narratives) — the on-ramp stays outcome-first.
- **Tactical:** For anyone who works with knowledge, Spectrea is the composable intelligence platform that turns scattered information into compounding intelligence — unlike fragmented point solutions that silo your knowledge and hide their reasoning.

Messaging hierarchy

Primary theme is **Connection** — the headline "We connect the dots" and the idea that scattered knowledge becomes one living view. Three supporting themes:

1. **Trustworthy Intelligence** — "Intelligence you can trust." Everything you see is transparent; every action is reviewable.
2. **Compounding Intelligence** — "It gets smarter with every interaction." Your second year is measurably sharper than your first — more context retained, more decisions traceable, more outcomes feeding the next cycle. *Guardrail:* use "compounding intelligence" only with its defensible mechanism named — provenance, per-viewer access, and the closed loop that feeds outcomes back in. The phrase is contested in-market (noted 2026-07-03); the mechanism, not the slogan, carries the claim.
3. **Composability** — "Build exactly what you need." Simple, combinable parts assembled into any solution.

Archetypes — three facets, one motion

Spectrea is **one character**, not three. The traditional archetypes — Magician, Sage, Creator — operate as inseparable facets of a single gesture: **reveal** → **ground** → **equip**. Every brand moment (marketing hero, error screen, editor interaction) carries all three; the emphasis shifts with context, the character doesn't.

Facet	Movement	What it does
Reveal (Magician)	Brings the hidden pattern into view	The moment of seeing what was always there but never noticed — the insight surfacing, the connection clicking. Without reveal, copy is flat; nothing feels discovered.
Ground (Sage)	Shows the evidence	The calm of being able to see exactly how something is true — sources, confidence, traceable logic. Without ground, reveal is hype.
Equip (Creator)	Hands you the tools	Gives the user agency, stays out of the way. The joy of making something that's yours. Without equip, the brand informs but never empowers.

Rule of three. If any of the three is missing, the copy doesn't sound like Spectrea. Reveal-without-ground is hype. Ground-without-equip is stuffy. Equip-without-reveal is tools without a reason.

The through-line is already encoded in the brand:

- **Tagline** — *We connect the dots* = see them (reveal) · trust them (ground) · build on them (equip).
- **Strategic claim** — *"See it whole. Trust what you see. Build on what you find."* (literally reveal → ground → equip).
- **Voice formula** — *"Clarity of explanation [ground] + experiential momentum [reveal]. Tech earns its place by showing its work [equip]."*

Personality (four traits with guardrails)

- **Warm** — respects the person behind every interaction. *Guardrail: not soft — trust users to be capable.*
- **Perceptive** — sees patterns others miss; surfaces connections, then steps back. *Guardrail: not presumptuous — suggests, never dictates.*
- **Grounded** — powerful but never pretentious; substance over style. *Guardrail: not boring — substance needs spark.*
- **Adaptive** — meets you where you are; same system, different depths. *Guardrail: not shapeless — Spectrea has a point of view.*

The brand's *consistency and discipline* — fixed primitives, fixed palette, fixed motion language — is enforced structurally by the system rules in the sections below, not claimed as a personality trait.

Emotional core

Empowerment + Clarity. Feeling more capable because Spectrea helped you see clearly and choose wisely. Like putting on glasses — everything that was blurry snaps into focus.

Visual metaphor

Prism + Living Network — explicitly co-primary (ratified 2026-08-06). Two metaphors with distinct roles; neither is secondary. The **Prism** carries identity and reveal — raw information enters, organised insight exits; hidden structure made visible (the etymology echo: the name comes from it). The **Living Network** carries product and growth — a web of connections that grows denser and more intelligent with every interaction (the promise: it grows with you). When a surface needs a single lead, role decides: identity/reveal surfaces lead with the Prism, product/growth surfaces lead with the Living Network.

Aesthetic direction

Warm + Intelligent. Like a brilliant mentor — approachable yet deep. Rich colours, inviting spacing, feels human. References: Stripe, Linear (clarity through restraint). Tradeoff: **power over polish** — capability is sacred; elegance is valued but never at the cost of depth.

Values

1. **Human-First** — Spectrea serves people, not the other way around. AI assists understanding; it never replaces judgment. Your data is sovereign: full-fidelity export — structure, data, and provenance — is a first-class guarantee. You can always leave with everything.
2. **Trustworthy Intelligence** — everything you see is transparent; every action is reviewable; every connection can be followed back. Truth is per-viewer: what you see is synthesized from exactly the claims you can access — coexisting perspectives stay attributed, and nothing leaks from views you can't see.
3. **Compounding Intelligence** — the more you use it, the more it gives back.
4. **Composable by Nature** — build solutions that fit your world; don't reshape your world to fit a tool.
5. **Accessible Power** — deep capability that meets you where you are. The floor is high, and the ceiling rises with you.

Anti-values (what Spectrea never does)

- Never replaces human judgment.
- Never leaves anyone behind.
- Never complex or bloated — if it needs a consultant, we failed.
- Never a black box — you can always ask "why?" and get an answer.

Audiences

Five personas — the solo tier is first-class, not a trial. Mirrored from `brand.audiences` :

Persona	Who	Need	Message
Solo Knowledge Workers	Independent researchers, writers, consultants, students — anyone building a personal knowledge practice	A system that compounds from day one, alone — free and full-featured, no team required.	<i>"Start free, alone, with the full system. Your knowledge starts compounding with the first document — and when you're ready, invite a few collaborators without switching tools."</i>

Persona	Who	Need	Message
Business Leaders	CEOs, COOs, Managing Directors	Strategic clarity. See what the organization actually knows — and what it's missing.	<i>"In a world drowning in data, Spectrea surfaces the intelligence that matters — connected, verified, and compounding with every interaction."</i>
Knowledge Workers	Analysts, researchers, consultants	Find trusted connections across sources. Build on what exists instead of reinventing.	<i>"Stop hunting through 12 tools for information you can't verify. Spectrea connects your knowledge into one living, trustworthy graph."</i>
Technology Leaders	CTOs, IT Directors, architects	A composable, inspectable, extensible knowledge substrate.	<i>"Composable. Transparent. Built on primitives, not opinions. A platform that earns the trust of an engineering culture that asks 'why' before adopting anything."</i>
Growing Teams	Startup founders, team leads	Preserve institutional knowledge. Turn tribal knowledge into collective intelligence.	<i>"Every conversation, every document, every decision — captured in a graph that compounds. When someone leaves, their insights stay."</i>

Breadth path: The designed path: start free alone (full-featured) → invite a few collaborators (bounded invites stay free) → pay when capacity or admin scale demands it. The paid line is capacity and governance administration, never a crippled core — value arrives before payment.

Differentiators

Anchored to the moat: per-viewer truth, graph-resident decisions with provenance, outcomes feeding the next cycle, one substrate from solo to institution.

Spectrea	Traditional tools
Per-viewer truth — coexisting, attributed perspectives; each viewer sees a synthesis of exactly what they can access	One forced record — or per-user silos that never combine
Decisions live in the graph — choices, doctrines, and commitments carry provenance and stay queryable	Decisions evaporate into chat scroll and meeting notes
Outcomes feed back — what happened sharpens what the system knows next	Static — same value on day 1 and day 1000

Spectrea	Traditional tools
One substrate, solo to institution — the same system grows from one person to an organization	A personal tool you outgrow, or an enterprise platform too heavy to start small
Transparent and verifiable — everything you see is shown, and every connection can be followed back	Black box — data goes in, answers come out
Composable — build exactly what you need from simple parts	Fixed — use what you're given
Sovereign by default — private, and fully exportable with structure and provenance	Open by default, hard to leave — data leaks in, value locks in

Guardrail: never position on retrieval or search quality — it is commoditized across the field. The graph earns its keep through governance, provenance, shared state, and the loop; differentiate on what the substrate makes structural.

2. Voice & Tone

Voice formula

Clarity of explanation + experiential momentum. Tech earns its place by showing its work.

The formula applies on every surface. Spectrea earns trust by *showing its work* — the reasoning, the evidence, the source — not by claiming magic.

One voice — three facets in every moment

The voice formula is triadic by construction. Every piece of Spectrea copy — regardless of surface — should carry all three facets together. What shifts with context is which facet leads:

- On marketing, **reveal** leads — it is the register of the canonical hero-open rule (§2, Voice & Tone): the open lands on the outcome, written as the moment of new sight, *then* grounds it with specifics, *then* invites the reader to try it.
- On trust surfaces (errors, docs, settings, security), **ground** leads. The message starts with what is true, *reveals* the underlying cause, and *equips* the reader with the next step.
- On product, **equip** leads. The copy hands the user the tool, makes the result *visible* (reveal), and surfaces the reasoning when asked (ground).

The facet that leads changes; the other two are always present. A marketing page that only reveals is hype. A doc page that only grounds is stuffy. A product screen that only equips is a toolbar. Spectrea reads as Spectrea when all three are in every moment.

Tone registers (one taxonomy, ratified 2026-08-08)

Six content classes, each with a tone label and the right (left) and wrong (right) version. Read each pair together — the contrast is what the rule looks like in practice. Two structures, two jobs: these registers say how a content class *sounds*; the surface patterns below say what a product surface *says* (a surface inherits its register from the nearest content class — system notifications from Error Message, release notes from Feature Announcement).

Context · Tone	Right	Wrong
Marketing / Landing Page · Bold + Direct	<i>"See everything your organization knows in one connected view. Spectrea builds a living graph from your documents — the more you use it, the sharper it gets."</i>	<i>"Transform how your team works. Unlock the power of connected knowledge — insights, intelligence, impact."</i>
Error Message · Direct + Informative	<i>"Save failed: connection timeout. Your draft is cached locally. Retrying..."</i>	<i>"Oops! Something went wrong. Please try again later or contact support if the problem persists."</i>
Feature Announcement · Concrete + Confident	<i>"Every document you add now strengthens what the system already knows. Connections you never noticed start surfacing. The whole gets sharper — your second month is better than your first."</i>	<i>"We're excited to share our latest update — it includes improvements that will help you be more productive."</i>
Documentation · Precise + Helpful	<i>"To add a new item, open the relevant view and choose 'Add'. Pick a type from the list, or create one if you need it. The item appears in place immediately."</i>	<i>"Ready to add something? Just head over to the right view and hit that '+ Add' button! Pick a type that fits — or make a new one if nothing works. Easy!"</i>
Social Media · Thoughtful + Engaging	<i>"What if every document you uploaded made your whole system smarter? That's not a hypothetical — it's how Spectrea works."</i>	<i>"Team productivity has never been easier. Learn how Spectrea can transform your workflow."</i>
Beginner Documentation · Plain + Welcoming	<i>"Think of Spectrea as a web of everything your team knows. When you add a document, Spectrea reads it and weaves what it learns into the web — connecting it to things you've already captured."</i>	<i>"Documents are processed through a 6-phase pipeline: parse, chunk, embed, score, review, and integrate."</i>

The right-hand versions are bold, direct, concrete — they show what the user experiences. The wrong-hand versions fail in different ways: platitude-marketing (*transform, unlock, impact*), bland agentless announcement (*we're excited to share*), vague apology, forced chirp, clickbait, or engineer-internal jargon in a beginner context. In every case, the brand shows its work rather than claiming magic or reaching for the nearest SaaS cliché.

Two context shifts live within this same voice. **On buyer surfaces** (hero, case studies, pricing), the open lands on the outcome (hero-open rule below); proof carries the grounding — a named customer, a concrete outcome, or a peer-testable claim. Brand vocabulary decorates; it doesn't carry the opening. **Inside the product**, warm up one notch. Warmth comes from specificity, not exclamation points — *"Read. 12 entities, 18 connections added."* beats *"Upload complete!"* 🎨 because the first shows the system paid attention.

The hero-open (one canonical rule, ratified 2026-08-07). Open on the outcome, written as a reveal — the moment of new sight. Never open with the mechanism, the pain alone, or a platitude. Ground it next with a specific the reader can check; close by equipping the next step. The gesture adapts to any surface — a problem may set up the reveal, proof may carry the grounding — but the open always lands on the outcome. Exception: graph-native jobs (exploration, visualisation), where the graph is the star and may lead.

On-ramp posture (decided by Darren 2026-07-03; amended 2026-07-19). Outcome-first hero per the canonical hero-open rule above: the hero leads with the entry job and its outcome, written as a reveal. One coined whole-product frame is sanctioned (ratified 2026-07-19): **"the operating system for collective intelligence"** — distinct from generic "AI OS", always paired with plain language that carries the meaning. The sanctioned hero example: *"Drop in your docs — get answers that show their sources, and a system that gets sharper every week."* Adopt the market's words where they exist: *permission-aware · cited answers · grounded answers · knowledge graph* (exploration surfaces only — the graph stays supporting-cast). Avoid-list terms — *Work AI · organizational memory · AI workspace · AI OS · second brain · ambient agents · bitemporal · ontology · enterprise graph* — follow the **balance doctrine** (ratified 2026-07-19): industry terms are not blacklisted or censored; an avoid-list term may label a segment-matched surface when a plain-language claim carries the meaning in place (e.g. "second brain" on the individuals page). Do not expect the term to carry weight with unfamiliar audiences; balance it, and never lead a cross-segment hero with it. Coin language ONLY for the differentiators no market term names: **per-viewer truth, decisions in the graph**, and the whole-product frame **"the operating system for collective intelligence"** (pair it with plain language — it must not carry the claim alone). Everywhere else, use the market's word where one exists (adopt list) or plain outcome language.

Surface patterns

Voice patterns for product and operational surfaces the register taxonomy doesn't cover — what each surface *says*, inheriting its register from the nearest content class above. Release notes follow the Feature Announcement register.

Surface	Rule	Right	Wrong
Onboarding	Orient by doing, not touring. First screens name the one action that creates value and get out of the way. No feature carousels, no "welcome to the future".	<i>"Add your first document. Spectrea reads it and starts connecting it to what you add next."</i>	<i>"Welcome to Spectrea! 🎉 Let's take a quick tour of all the powerful features that will transform how you work."</i>
Empty states	An empty state is an invitation with a promise, not an apology. Name what will appear here and the single step that starts it.	<i>"No connections yet. Add a second document and related ideas start linking up here."</i>	<i>"Nothing to see here yet!"</i>
Confirmation dialogs	State the consequence plainly, in the user's terms — what happens, what's reversible, what isn't. The confirm button names the action, never "OK".	<i>"Delete this source? Its 14 extracted claims stay in the graph but lose their citation. This can't be undone."</i>	<i>"Are you sure you want to proceed? This action may have consequences. [OK] [Cancel]"</i>
System notifications	Specificity is the warmth. Report what the system actually did, with numbers where they exist. No celebration, no vagueness.	<i>"Read. 12 entities, 18 connections added."</i>	<i>"Upload complete! 🎉 Your document has been processed successfully."</i>
Settings & security	Ground leads. Say exactly what a setting does and what changes when it's toggled — especially for privacy and access. Plain sentences, no marketing.	<i>"Workspace visibility: private. Only people you invite can see anything in this workspace — including the assistant, which sees only what each viewer can see."</i>	<i>"Take control of your data with our industry-leading privacy options!"</i>
Legal & compliance	Same voice, zero warmth-decoration: precise, complete sentences that a lawyer and a reader both accept. State facts and obligations; never soften a limitation into a benefit.	<i>"You can export your full workspace — structure, data, and provenance — at any time. Deleting your account removes your data from live systems within 30 days."</i>	<i>"Don't worry — your data is always safe with us, and leaving is a breeze!"</i>

Surface	Rule	Right	Wrong
Support replies	Ground, then equip: confirm what happened (own it plainly if it's our fault), state what's true now, give the exact next step. Never open with an apology template.	<i>"You're right — sync failed for files added between 09:10 and 09:40 UTC. They're queued and will finish within the hour; nothing was lost. I'll reply here when they're through."</i>	<i>"We sincerely apologize for any inconvenience this may have caused. Your satisfaction is our top priority."</i>

Vocabulary — twelve privileged words

The twelve brand-evocative words that should appear disproportionately often in copy. Each builds the *feeling* of Spectrea — clarity, aliveness, ownership, the act of seeing — without requiring the reader to know what the product does.

Privileged words: spectrum, clarity, whole, see, reveal, illuminate, surface, connect, compose, compound, alive, transparent.

Generic B2B SaaS words (insights, intelligence, transform, empower, unlock, enable, build, evolve, grow, deepen, expand) are still allowed but not privileged — they don't make Spectrea sound like Spectrea. Product-specific words (provenance, traceable, auditable, attributed, sourced) are also allowed and useful when describing what the product actually does — they just don't do brand voice work.

Words we never use: AI-powered (overused), next-gen, state-of-the-art, world-class, breakthrough, unprecedented, game-changer, revolutionary, seamless, cutting-edge, synergy, leverage (as a verb), agentic, AI-first, copilot (as a generic noun), 10x, supercharge, effortless, magical.

Density. Max two privileged words per paragraph, one *"living"* / *"alive"* per page. If a paragraph survives losing every privileged word, the prose is doing its job — if it collapses without them, rewrite.

3. Naming

- **Spelling:** Spectrea (capital S, no space).
- **Pronunciation:** /spek-TREE-uh/ — emphasis on the second syllable.
- **Etymology — dual reading:** a coinage from *spectrum* (Latin, from *specere*, "to look"; plural *spectra* — the full range). The name does double duty:
 - **Reading 1 — Spectrum:** the full range. The complete view. The whole picture, all in one place.

- **Reading 2 — Revealing:** bringing what was hidden into clear view. The shift from blur to focus.
- Together: *the spectrum of clarity* — and the action behind the tagline "We connect the dots."
- **Never:** "SpectreAI" · "Spectre" / "Spectra" (different words) · "spectra" (missing the e) · "Spectrea AI" as the lead name (AI is not the brand) · "SPECTREA" (all-caps) · lowercase "spectrea" in headings or prose (lowercase belongs to the logo wordmark treatment only) · "The Spectrea" (no article) · random internal caps ("SpecTrea").

Feature naming convention

Apple-style: Title-case Proper Nouns without brand prefix. Each first-class feature stands on its own; the platform context (Spectrea) is implicit. The convention applies to whatever Spectrea ships, today or in the future.

Pattern	Form
Generic noun (in prose)	lowercase ("the assistant", "the editor")
First-class feature (canonical)	Title-Case Proper Noun ("Assistant", "Editor")
Multi-word feature	Each significant word capitalised ("Spectrum View")
Distinct branded surface	"Spectrea X" — only after deliberate review

Three rules:

1. **Default:** Title-case Proper Noun for first-class features. The capital signals "this is a named thing in Spectrea."
2. **Brand-prefix:** reserved for distinct branded surfaces — separately-paid tiers, developer surfaces, installable companions. Only after deliberate review (a hypothetical *Spectrea Studio* would qualify).
3. **In running prose:** lowercase generic nouns are acceptable when natural ("the assistant suggested"). Canonical name in marketing headers, documentation cross-references, and product UI labels.

Naming the AI

Three registers (ratified 2026-07-19). **(1) Homepage/hero narrative:** "your AI" is sanctioned to match the hero register. **(2) Product and trust surfaces:** the AI is "**the assistant**" — lowercase, generic; as a first-class feature name it is "**Assistant**" (Title-Case, per the feature-naming convention). **(3) Technical and architecture writing:** "agent" is the umbrella term for an accountable AI actor (delegate or standing agent), per the vision taxonomy — the assistant is the delegate shape's product realization. Never "copilot" (generic or name), never "Spectrea AI" as a name.

The assistant suggests, surfaces, and drafts — it never silently "handles it for you" or "takes over". Automations act within guardrails the user sets: the user decides what runs on its own and what checks with you first (per the vision's governed-autonomy model). Never describe autonomy without naming its guardrail; never use approval-begging framings ("waiting for your yes").

Allowed verbs: suggests · surfaces · drafts. **Forbidden verbs:** handles it for you · takes over.

Company vs product

Matchwise Pte. Ltd. is the legal entity — it appears only where a legal entity is required: contracts, invoices, terms, privacy notices ("Spectrea is a product of Matchwise Pte. Ltd.").

Spectrea is the product and brand name on every public surface. Never brand a surface "Matchwise"; never combine the two into one name. Earlier material using the company name as a product or brand name is superseded.

4. Logo System



Anatomy

The logo has three parts:

1. **Mark** — the "connecting the dots" S-curve. 10 dots along a cubic Bézier path, with the final two visually trailing. Spectrum-gradient stroke connecting the first eight. The mark also reads as the leading `S` glyph in the lockup.
2. **Wordmark** — Albert Sans Semibold 600, 0.02em letter-spacing. Inside the canonical `Logotype` / `LogotypeGradient` components, the S mark replaces the leading `S` and only the tail `pectrea` is typeset in lowercase — a stylistic treatment, not the typed name. In every other context (manual lockups like the sidebar, descriptor variants, prose, headings, URLs-excepted), use the sentence-case `Spectrea` — the mark sits beside it as a companion glyph rather than a letter substitute.
3. **Lockup** — S mark + lowercase wordmark.

Construction (K3' geometry + "B" lockup constants, ratified 2026-08-06)

- **Spine:** 3 G1-continuous cubics fitted to the Albert Sans 600 S medial axis, with a deliberate shallow storytelling tail. Authoritative coordinates: `brand.ts` `logo.markGeometry` (record: docs/brand-review-2026-08).
- **Dots:** 10 dots at $i/9$ arc fractions of the spine, radius 3.961 (native units; dot diameter : stroke width stays 7:8). Grey (`#A3A3A3`) in the primary treatment.
- **Stroke:** width 9.053 (native units), round linecap. Cool Duet (Cobalt `#4271DF` → Teal `#00B6A0`) in the static mark and in the gradient lockup's mark. In the lockup the rendered stroke equals the wordmark's stem: **0.113em**.
- **Trailing dots:** the last 2 dots are left visually unconnected — the "about to connect" moment.
- **Lockup metrics (on ink, never bounding boxes):** mark ink height 0.714em (= the real S glyph's ink), mark→text ink gap 0.131em (= S right side bearing + 0.02em tracking + p left side bearing), mark ink bottom at baseline + 0.007em (the S's baseline overshoot). Wordmark: Albert Sans **600** at every size, 0.02em tracking.
- **Container:** 64×64 construction viewBox. Circle when contained — never a squircle.
- **Small sizes:** No micro-construction (ratified 2026-08-06, decision 11): the standard mark scales down unchanged at every size. Below ~24px the trailing dots read as part of the stroke; that plain-S reading is accepted.

The two-forms rule (lockup)

The lockup has **exactly two forms** — no third:

1. **Gradient lockup** — `LogotypeGradient` component. S mark carries the two-tone Cool Duet (Cobalt `#4271DF` → Teal `#00B6A0`) on the stroke only; all dots stay grey. The wordmark is monotone — Ink on light, White on dark — following the `colorMode` prop.
2. **Mono lockup** — `Logotype` component. Everything renders in a single `ink` / `white` / `grey` colour.

 Spectrea



 Spectrea



The dark-surface file (`logo-lockup-gradient-white.svg`) is not a third form — it is form 1's "White on dark" wordmark rendering, shipped as its own asset for dark and photographic surfaces. (Resolved 2026-07-03: an earlier draft shipped this asset under the misnomer "spectrum-white"; Darren ratified re-scoping it to the gradient family — no full-spectrum lockup exists.)

The gradient lives in the mark only. No gradient-filled wordmark, no full-spectrum lockup — the wordmark is always solid so it stays legible at every size. Duets (Balanced / Warm) belong to the static mark only; they are not lockup options.

Mark colour modes

- `'color'` — full spectrum (Cobalt → Teal → Amber). Default for `AnimatedLogo` . Used for hero moments.
- `'cool'` — Cool Duet (Cobalt → Teal). Default for `StaticLogo` . Primary static mark for everyday use.
- `'balanced'` — Balanced Duet (Teal → `#6FB884` at 65% → Amber). For product/ecosystem moments.
- `'warm'` — Warm Duet (Amber → Rose). For marketing attention.
- `'grey'` — Pewter. Watermarks only.
- `'white'` — Canvas `#FDFDFB` . Dark backgrounds.
- `'ink'` — Ink `#18181C` . Formal, co-branding, single-colour print.

Dot-colour rule

- **Mono mode** (`ink` / `white` / `grey`) → dots match the mark — not grey.
- **Gradient/duet mode** → dots are grey (`#A3A3A3`). This is the primary brand treatment.
- **Exception:** the intentional "Ink + Grey Dots" variant labelled *Quiet authority* — connection formed, spectrum dormant.

Variants (11 approved)

On light backgrounds:

1. Primary mark (Cool Duet, grey dots)
2. Primary lockup
3. Ink mark
4. Ink lockup
5. Grey mark (watermark only)

On dark backgrounds: 6. Primary on dark (Cool Duet + grey dots) 7. Primary lockup on dark 8. White mark 9. White lockup

Contained (below 48px): 10. Ink circle (white mark on ink fill) 11. White circle (ink mark on white fill)

Lockup arrangements (three)

1. **Gradient logotype** — LogotypeGradient . Preferred for brand/marketing.
2. **Horizontal with descriptor** — StaticLogo + sentence-case Spectrea wordmark + descriptor below. For nav, product headers, sub-brands. Descriptor styling: gap-3 between mark and wordmark column, text-xs , uppercase, tracking-widest, Pewter (#97979E). Because this is a manual composition (not the canonical Logotype component), the mark sits beside the wordmark as a companion glyph — the S is not dropped, and the word is typed Spectrea exactly as in running prose.
3. **Stacked** — mark above wordmark. For title slides, centered compositions. Wordmark width $\leq$ mark width.

When to use which variant

Context	Variant	Why
Website header (light)	Logotype	Preferred horizontal treatment
Website header (dark)	Logotype (white)	White logotype on dark
Product sidebar / nav	#1 + descriptor	Primary mark with descriptor
Favicon (16–32px)	#10	Ink circle — high contrast small
App icon	#10	Bold, distinctive in app grids
Social avatar	#10	Circular crop on most platforms
Social cover image	#2 or #7	Full lockup, match cover background
Marketing hero	Logotype or stacked	Logotype inline; stacked centered
Co-branding	#3 or #4	Ink prevents colour competition; match the partner mark by optical height — scale so perceived heights are equal, not bounding boxes — and align on the marks' vertical centres
Legal / formal	#4	Ink lockup — authoritative, max contrast

Context	Variant	Why
Watermark	#5 at ≤20% opacity	Grey mark, subtle
Emboss / foil stamp	#3	Single-tone production

Co-branding (canonical rule): Use the ink variants (#3 mark / #4 lockup). Match the partner mark by optical height — scale so perceived heights are equal, not bounding boxes — and align on the marks’ vertical centres.

Clear space

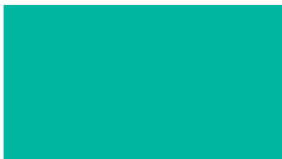
Minimum clear space around the lockup: 0.5× the mark height on all sides. No other graphic element (text, border, background image) enters the clear-space box.

Misuse

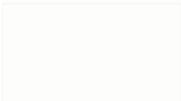
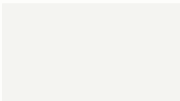
Never: stretch or distort · change colours (spectrum gradient is Cobalt → Teal → Amber; never substitute) · rotate · add drop shadows, glows, bevels · use only the stroke path without dots · use on low-contrast backgrounds (< 2.5:1) · change dot count (always exactly 10) · swap mark and wordmark positions · violate clear space · use a squircle container (always round) · colour the dots in the primary treatment · substitute the wordmark typeface.

5. Colour System

SPECTRUM ACCENTS

			
Cobalt #4271DF	Teal #00B6A0	Amber #E19000	Rose #F24260

WARM BLEND NEUTRALS (OKLCH-EVEN LADDER)

						
Canvas #F0F0F8	Cloud #F4F4F1	Pewter #97979E	Slate #606072	Iron #46464B	Graphite #212226	Ink #18181C

BRIDGE TIER (TINTED WASHES)

Cobalt Wash #EDF0F8	Teal Mist #E6F5F3	Amber Stone #F5F0E6	Rose Blush #FDF0F2

Spectrum is the brand signature

The four-colour spectrum (Cobalt + Teal + Amber + Rose) is the brand’s central visual claim — comparable to how Google’s four colours signal Google or Microsoft’s four squares signal Microsoft. In **marketing surfaces**, the spectrum is used confidently as the brand’s identity: hero gradients, full-spectrum illustration moments, spectrum lockups, the lockup gradient as the signature mark treatment.

In **product UI**, the same four colours stay strictly *semantic* (Tier 3 framework below): Cobalt for action, Teal for success, Amber for attention, Rose for urgency. The discipline doesn’t change; only the airtime does. Marketing spends budget on spectrum hero moments; product reserves it for meaning.

Warm Blend neutrals (applied system-wide)

A subtle warm tint layered under the spectrum — closes the gap between cold Tailwind grays and the warm accents. Seven tokens, perceptually-uniform in OKLCH L-space from surface to primary text.

Role	Name	Hex	OKLCH L	Contrast on Canvas	CSS var
Background	Canvas	#FDFDFB	0.993	1:1	--color-canvas
Elevated surface	Cloud	#F4F4F1	0.966	1.08:1	--color-cloud
Whisper muted	Pewter	#97979E	0.679	2.85:1	--color-pewter
Body secondary	Slate	#6D6D72	0.537	5.05:1	--color-slate
Emphasized body	Iron	#46464B	0.395	9.21:1	--color-iron
Dark UI surface	Graphite	#212226	0.253	15.6:1	--color-graphite
Primary text / dark bg	Ink	#18181C	0.211	17.4:1	--color-ink

The seven tokens form an OKLCH-even ladder ($\Delta L \approx 0.14$ through the body range, with tighter pairs at each end: Canvas↔Cloud and Graphite↔Ink). Slate and Iron exist because the body-text hierarchy needs three working tiers (quiet / body / emphasized) and the old five-token

palette had a single ~0.43-wide L gap between Pewter and Graphite with nothing in between.

Spectrum accents (the four spectrum colours)

Role	Name	Hex	Meaning
Hero / primary	Cobalt	#4271DF	Intelligence, trust, focus. One primary action per section.
Positive / growth	Teal	#00B6A0	Success, growth, connected status.
Attention	Amber	#E19000	Warnings, pending, confidence.
Urgency / action	Rose	#F24260	Errors, destructive actions, critical alerts.

Hover/active states for each accent (light surfaces — darken on interaction):

- Cobalt: base #4271DF , hover #3A63C4 , active #3255A7 .
- Teal: base #00B6A0 , hover #009E8A , active #008775 .
- Amber: base #E19000 , hover #C58200 , active #A86E00 .
- Rose: base #F24260 , hover #D63B55 , active #BA3249 .

Dark surfaces (resolved 2026-07-04) — same bases, states lighten instead: Cobalt hover #6E93EC / active #8FACF0 · Teal hover #20C8B2 / active #40D4C3 · Amber hover #ECA41E / active #F2B63C · Rose hover #F56579 / active #F78892 . On dark surfaces the button lifts toward the light: hover and active fills lighten, and the label flips from White to Ink #18181C while the fill is lightened. Base states keep white text. Ink-on-lightened-fill contrast, verified 2026-07-04 (cobalt re-lightened 2026-08-08, D40 — the old hover #5C87E5 read APCA Lc 40.5, below the 45 spot line; the new ladder puts every dark transient state at APCA parity): cobalt hover 5.94 / active 7.86, rose hover 5.92 / active 7.50, teal hover 8.40 / active 9.63, amber hover 8.34 / active 9.72 — all ≥ 4.5:1 (AA, normal text). Dark secondary: bg #2E2F35 , hover #3A3A40 , text Cloud #F4F4F1 .

Bridge tier (tinted washes)

Tiered between the neutral canvas and the vivid accents — 5–10% saturation versions of each spectrum colour. Always carry semantic meaning; never decorative.

Name	Hex	Paired accent	Use
Cobalt Wash	#EDF0F8	Cobalt	Info alert background, selected row (text on wash: #1E3A8A)
Teal Mist	#E6F5F3	Teal	Success toast, positive trend card (text on wash: #0D5E56)
Amber Stone	#F5F0E6	Amber	Warning alert, highlighted callout (text on wash: #7C4D04)

Name	Hex	Paired accent	Use
Rose Blush	#FDF0F2	Rose	Error message, destructive confirmation (text on wash: #9F1239)

Text on a dark wash is Cloud #F4F4F1; text on a light wash uses that wash's textOn value (or Ink) — never the raw accent.

Text hierarchy — which token for which tier

The three dark-on-light text tiers map cleanly to the Warm Blend's three readable tokens:

Tier	Token	Contrast	Use for
Primary	Ink #18181C	17.4:1	Headings, stat values, body emphasis, logo wordmark
Emphasized body	Iron #46464B	9.21:1 (AAA)	Table headers, field labels, key body sentences
Body secondary	Slate #6D6D72	5.05:1 (AA)	Descriptions, helper text, card sub-labels, secondary prose
Whisper muted	Pewter #97979E	2.85:1	Supplementary labels only — see below

Pewter is a whisper, not a readable tier. Its 2.85:1 contrast is below WCAG AA large-text (3:1). This is an intentional trade: the whisper register is part of what makes the Warm Blend feel warm rather than clinical. As a matrix — **allowed:** overlines, timestamps, meta chips, placeholder text, and captions where the adjacent context already makes the content obvious; **denied:** any informational text — anything that must be *read on its own* steps up to Slate (body secondary) or Iron (emphasized).

Tailwind → Warm Blend mapping

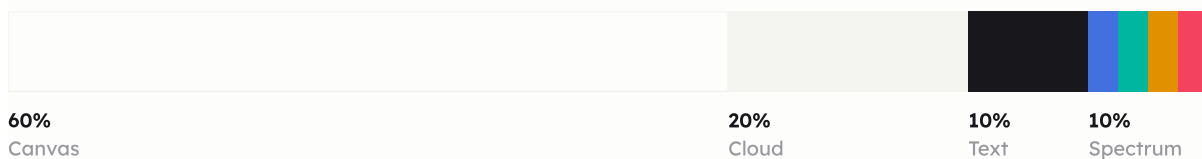
The app uses Tailwind utility classes; the Warm Blend tokens are exported into the @theme so the brand names are first-class utilities. The required mapping:

Tailwind stone class	Brand token	Notes
text-stone-900 , text-stone-800	text-ink	primary
text-stone-700 , text-stone-600	text-iron	emphasized body
text-stone-500	text-slate	body secondary

Tailwind stone class	Brand token	Notes
<code>text-stone-400</code> , <code>text-stone-300</code>	<code>text-pewter</code>	whisper — never for informational text
<code>bg-stone-50</code> , <code>bg-stone-100</code>	<code>bg-cloud</code>	elevated surface
<code>bg-stone-800</code>	<code>bg-ink</code>	active dark fill (Tier 2 Structural)
<code>border-stone-*</code>	keep as-is	Tailwind stones are the sanctioned border family
<code>bg-stone-200</code> , <code>bg-stone-300</code>	keep as-is	hover / active / press backgrounds, skeleton placeholders

Colour ratio (the 60/20/10/10 rule)

- **60%** Canvas (page background)
- **20%** Cloud (elevated surfaces: cards, sidebars, dropdowns)
- **10%** Ink + Pewter (text and UI)
- **10%** Spectrum accents (semantic moments only)



Tiered colour framework

Every colour in Spectrea lives in one of three tiers:

- 1. Tier 1 — Responsive (Cobalt).** Action-oriented elements — things that trigger an operation. Temporary and reactive: present during hover, focus, press, then settles. Primary buttons, links, CTAs, input focus, hovered icons.
- 2. Tier 2 — Structural (Ink).** Persistent state and navigation. Active nav item, selected tab, toggled-on icon, current breadcrumb. Ink keeps the canvas calm while Cobalt stays reserved for action.
- 3. Tier 3 — Semantic (spectrum + Pewter).** The system communicating status. Info (Cobalt), success (Teal), warning (Amber), error (Rose). Never decorative — every appearance carries meaning.

Default mode: light

Spectrea defaults to **light**. Canvas `#FDFDFB` is the 60% page ground because the Warm Blend system exists to make the spectrum feel inhabited against a warm-tinted white — not to produce a dark-first interface. Marketing, product, and PDF surfaces all ship light-default. Dark is a parallel mode, not the primary register.

Dark surfaces (parallel mode)

On dark surfaces, the role mapping **inverts** — existing tokens carry more of the weight, with two additions for hierarchy.

Role	Light	Dark	CSS var
Page background	Canvas #FDFDFB	Ink #18181C	--dark-canvas
Elevated surface	Cloud #F4F4F1	Graphite #212226	--dark-cloud
Primary text	Ink #18181C	Cloud #F4F4F1	--dark-ink
Muted text	Pewter #97979E	Mist #B0B0B6 (new)	--dark-mist
Border / divider	stone-200	Fog #2E2F35 (new)	--dark-fog

Why two new tokens and not more. Pewter on Ink reads ~6.3:1 — fine for body — but muted text needs to sit *above* body hierarchy on dark. **Mist** #B0B0B6 is Pewter brightened to ~8.5:1 so "secondary" still feels secondary without fighting primary text. **Fog** #2E2F35 gives separation without a visible line — lighter than Ink, darker than Graphite, so cards feel edged rather than drawn.

Spectrum accents on dark

Three of four accents pass WCAG AA for normal text on Ink; Cobalt is **UI-only** at this contrast — for coloured text on Ink use Cobalt Lift instead. Accents carry over **unchanged** — the brand should read as itself on either surface.

Accent	On Ink contrast	Notes
Cobalt #4271DF	3.93:1	UI only (passes 3:1 for non-text UI). For coloured text on Ink use Cobalt Lift #7A9AEF .
Teal #00B6A0	6.91:1	AA normal text; AA large.
Amber #E19000	6.90:1	AA normal text; AA large.
Rose #F24260	4.82:1	AA normal text.

Optional brightened variants — only for long-form *coloured* text on dark (rare in practice). Use sparingly; default behaviour is "same hex, lighter surface."

Accent	Dark-lift	When
Cobalt Lift	#7A9AEF	Inline links inside dark long-form text blocks.

Accent	Dark-lift	When
Teal Lift	#3DD3BF	Coloured body copy on dark surfaces.
Amber Lift	#F2AE40	Coloured body copy on dark surfaces.
Rose Lift	#F97587	Coloured body copy on dark surfaces.

Dark bridge washes

Tinted dark surfaces — the semantic bridge tier rebuilt for dark mode. ~8–12% saturation on a dark base. Pair with the saturated accent the same way light washes do; the surface carries context, the dot/icon carries the colour.

Name	Hex	Paired accent	Use
Cobalt Deep	#1B2440	Cobalt	Info alert background, selected row (dark)
Teal Deep	#0E2E2A	Teal	Success toast, positive trend card (dark)
Amber Deep	#2E2410	Amber	Warning alert, highlighted callout (dark)
Rose Deep	#2E1218	Rose	Error message, destructive confirmation (dark)

Dark ratio

Same 60/20/10/10 discipline, inverted: **60% Ink · 20% Graphite · 10% Cloud + Mist · 10% spectrum (semantic only)**. The canvas still dominates; colour still earns its place.

When to use dark

- **Product UI** — follow the user's OS/app preference. Both modes are first-class.
- **Marketing** — light by default. Use Ink backgrounds for single-panel emphasis (quote card, stat card, section divider), not whole pages.
- **Presentations** — Canvas default; Ink for dividers and closing CTA ($\leq 20\%$ of deck). See §12.
- **PDF and print** — always light. Dark-mode PDFs waste ink and hurt readability.
- **Email** — transactional on Canvas; marketing headers may use Ink as a branded band, but the email body stays on Canvas.

Graph visualization colour semantics (foundation)

Graph surfaces follow the tiered framework — colour is reserved for meaning:

- **Node default:** neutral (Slate/Pewter strokes, Canvas/Cloud fills; inverted on dark). Structure is quiet.
- **Node hover/focus:** Cobalt (Tier 1 — responsive; present during hover/focus, then settles).
- **Node selected:** Ink (Tier 2 — structural; Cloud on dark).

- **Edges:** neutral (Pewter). A newly formed connection may animate with the Formation motion primitive — spectrum gradient along the stroke, settling to resting neutral.
- **Confidence:** Amber, with the value in JetBrains Mono — never conveyed by colour alone.
- **Status:** Teal success/connected · Amber warning/pending · Rose error/conflict · Cobalt info (Tier 3 — semantic).
- **Stale/dormant:** Pewter whisper plus a non-colour cue (icon or label).

Foundation only: the operational graph-rendering spec (sizing, layout, density, interaction physics) is a product-design deliverable, not a brand-guide deliverable.

6. Gradients

Three gradients — don't conflate them.

Primary brand gradient (the default)

Cobalt → **Teal** → **Amber** at 135°, interpolated in **OKLCH** on modern browsers with a clean sRGB fallback. This is the everyday brand gradient — hero sections, accent bars, dividers, decorative strips, progress indicators.



Brand gradient

`linear-gradient(135deg in oklch, #4271DF, #00B6A0, #E19000)` — sRGB fallback

Cross-browser CSS recipe

```
.brand-gradient {
  background: linear-gradient(135deg, #4271DF, #00B6A0, #E19000);
}
@supports (background: linear-gradient(in oklch, red, blue)) {
  .brand-gradient {
    background: linear-gradient(135deg in oklch, #4271DF, #00B6A0, #E19000);
  }
}
```

The `@supports` block is silently ignored by browsers that don't understand OKLCH (Chrome <111, Safari <16.2, Firefox <117) — they keep the sRGB base. Modern browsers apply the OKLCH override for a perceptually richer middle that avoids the muddy olive zone.

Lockup mark gradient (inside LogotypeGradient only)

Two-tone Cool Duet — the same gradient as the primary static mark. The wordmark stays monotone (Ink / White); only the mark carries colour.

0% #4271DF → 100% #00B6A0

Implemented in SVG (`<linearGradient>`). **Never used as a general-purpose decorative gradient.**



Lockup mark gradient — LogotypeGradient only, Cool Duet

0% #4271DF → 100% #00B6A0 (wordmark stays monotone Ink / White)

Full spectrum with Rose (sparingly)

Cobalt → Teal → Amber → Rose at 135°. Use only for peak brand expression — landing-page heroes, launch moments. Reserving it keeps its impact.



Full spectrum with Rose — marketing only, use sparingly

#4271DF → #00B6A0 → #E19000 → #F24260

Two-colour duets (adjacent pairs only)

Must use **adjacent** spectrum pairs. Skip pairs (Cobalt→Amber direct, Teal→Rose, Cobalt→Rose) break the continuous-spectrum metaphor and are off-brand.

- **Cool Duet** — Cobalt → Teal. Intelligence + growth. The resting-state duet. Used by the static S mark and data/technical contexts.
- **Balanced Duet** — Teal → #6FB884 at 65% → Amber. *Must* include the #6FB884 intermediate; without it, teal and amber desaturate into muddy olive. For product/ecosystem moments.
- **Warm Duet** — Amber → Rose. Energy + urgency. Marketing, launches, attention.



Cool Duet — intelligence + growth

#4271DF → #00B6A0



Balanced Duet — must include #6FB884 bridge

#00B6A0 → #6FB884 (65%) → #E19000



Warm Duet — energy + urgency

#E19000 → #F24260

Gradient rules

- **Use for:** logo mark background, hero accent bars, marketing page headers, loading progress bars, slide deck title dividers, social media profile accents.
- **Never for:** buttons (use solid Cobalt), text colour, body backgrounds, borders, small icons or badges, repeated elements.

7. Typography

We connect the dots.

ALBERT SANS BOLD 700 · 32px · Display / Hero

Composable intelligence platform.

ALBERT SANS SEMIBOLD 600 · 22px · H2 / Section heading

Every document you upload enriches your knowledge graph.

LEXEND REGULAR 400 · 16px · Body

entity.type: "Financial Model" | confidence: 0.94

JETBRAINS MONO REGULAR 400 · 13px · Code / Metadata

Type system (three typefaces)

Role	Family	Weights	Use
Headings	Albert Sans	600 (Semibold — incl. the logo wordmark at every size), 700 (Bold — hero headlines only)	Page titles, section headings, card titles, stat values

Role	Family	Weights	Use
Body	Lexend	300, 400, 500, 600	Body text, descriptions, form labels, nav items; 600 for overlines and small section labels (uppercase/tracked)
Code / metadata	JetBrains Mono	400	Inline code, data values, entity types, provenance

Minimum sizes. Body and prose: 16 px preferred, 14 px minimum. Captions and secondary labels: 12 px minimum. 10 px is permitted only for uppercase-tracked overlines, numeric badges, and metadata chips where the letter-spacing and weight restore legibility. Below 10 px is specimen-only (mini-preview UI illustrating another system at small scale) and must never appear in shipped production surfaces.

Type scale

Display

48px · line 1.1

Heading 1

36px · line 1.2

Heading 2

30px · line 1.25

Heading 3

24px · line 1.3

Heading 4

20px · line 1.4

Heading 5

18px · line 1.4

Body Large — leading paragraphs

18px · line 1.6

Body — default paragraphs

16px · line 1.6

Body SM — secondary text

14px · line 1.5

Caption — labels, timestamps

12px · line 1.5

OVERLINE — SECTION LABELS

12px · 0.05em tracking

code · data values · 0.94

14px · mono

code sm · trace details · technical metadata

12px · mono

Size	Value	Line height	Weight	Use
Display	48 px	1.1	600	Hero headlines, landing-page titles
H1	36 px	1.2	600	Page titles
H2	30 px	1.25	600	Major section headings

Size	Value	Line height	Weight	Use
H3	24 px	1.3	600	Sub-section headings, card titles
H4	20 px	1.4	600	Minor headings, dialog titles
H5	18 px	1.4	600	Sidebar section titles
Body LG	18 px	1.6	400	Lead paragraphs
Body	16 px	1.6	400	Default body text
Body SM	14 px	1.5	400	Secondary text, table cells, form inputs
Caption	12 px	1.5	500	Labels, timestamps, helper text
Overline	12 px	1.5	600	Section labels (uppercase + 0.05em tracking)
Code	14 px	1.5	400	Inline code, data values, type labels (JetBrains Mono)
Code SM	12 px	1.5	400	Trace details, technical metadata (JetBrains Mono)

Responsive scale

Desktop (1024+) / Tablet (640–1023) / Mobile (<640):

- Display: 48 / 36 / 30
- H1: 36 / 30 / 24
- H2: 30 / 24 / 20
- H3: 24 / 20 / 18
- Body / Body SM: unchanged across breakpoints.

Accessibility

The floor is **WCAG 2.2 AA** on every shipped surface.

- Body text minimum 16 px; never lower for primary content.
- Contrast ratio minimum: 4.5:1 for normal text, 3:1 for large/UI. On Canvas: Ink 17.4:1 · Iron 9.21:1 (AAA) · Slate 5.05:1 (AA) · Pewter 2.85:1 (supplementary only) — see the Pewter allow/deny matrix in §5.
- WCAG 2.2 specifics: Focus appearance: a visible focus indicator on every interactive element — the Amber focus ring (2 px solid, 2 px offset; Amber active #A86E00 on light surfaces, alpha-tinted Amber on dark) is the standard treatment · Target size: interactive targets at least 24×24 px, or the equivalent spacing exception · Dragging alternatives: any drag interaction (graph manipulation included) has a single-pointer, non-dragging alternative.
- Never rely on colour alone — pair colour coding with icons, patterns, or labels.
- Layout must not break at 200% browser text-zoom.

- **Measurement doctrine (adopted 2026-08-07):** Conformance floor: WCAG 2.x relative-luminance ratios (4.5:1 normal text; 3:1 large text and UI) — the metric automated checkers enforce and the level the brand publicly claims. Perceptual adjudicator: APCA-W3 Lc (the WCAG 3 draft model; ≥ 45 spot text, ≥ 60 fluent, ≥ 75 body) — consulted whenever the 2.x formula and trained eyes disagree, because 2.x under-credits light text on saturated mid-tone fills and over-credits dark-on-vivid. Exception grants record both metrics. OKLab/OKLCH lightness deltas may inform design exploration but are not conformance measures.
- **Exception registry** — deliberate, ratified departures from the floors; a sub-floor usage not listed here is a defect, not a style. One entry:
 - `semantic-button-labels-white` (ratified 2026-08-07): White #FFFFFF labels on semantic button base fills sit below the WCAG 2.x AA text floor on Rose, Teal, and Amber. **Measured** — **WCAG 2.x:** White on Cobalt 4.51:1 (AA), Rose 3.67:1, Teal 2.56:1, Amber 2.56:1; light-mode hover/active improve to 3.20–7.02:1; dark transient states flip to Ink and pass 5.92–9.72:1. **APCA:** White Lc on Cobalt 76.4, Rose 68.4, Teal 54.6, Amber 54.9 (hover/active 64.2–88.9) vs Ink Lc 31.7/39.6/53.0/52.7 — white beats or ties Ink on every fill, and every white pairing clears the APCA spot-text minimum (45) at base state. **Rationale:** The WCAG 2.x formula under-credits light text on saturated mid-tone fills and over-credits dark-on-vivid: the nominally compliant Ink-on-Rose swap (4.82:1) would measure APCA Lc 39.6 — perceptually worse than the white it replaced (68.4). White labels are perceptually equal-or-better everywhere and keep one consistent label rule across the semantic set. **Bounds:** Semantic action buttons only: short labels, ≥ 14 px Lexend Medium (500), reinforced by action context per the colour-alone rule. Covers light- and dark-surface base states (dark transient states still flip to Ink). Never body text, links, or long-form copy.

8. Iconography

Library: Tabler Icons (`react-icons/tb` — outline + filled from one library).

Specs:

- Style: outline by default; filled only for active/selected states.
- Stroke width: 2 px (Tabler default, consistent across all icons).
- Stroke caps/joins: round (matches the brand's warm personality).
- Grid: 24×24 px.
- Padding: 2 px inset — content stays within a 20 px live area.

Colour system (tiered):

- **Ink** (`#18181C`) — primary: nav, headings, actions.
- **Pewter** (`#97979E`) — secondary: helpers, disabled, muted.
- **Cobalt** (`#4271DF`) — active state, selected, links (hover responsive).

- **Cloud** (#F4F4F1) — on dark backgrounds.

Rule: never use spectrum accents (Teal, Amber, Rose) for decorative icons. Those colours are reserved for semantic meaning.

9. Illustration — v4 system

Spectrea's illustration system is two tracks: one universal prompt for hero scenes run through image generators, and a tight set of hand-coded SVG primitives for the schematic work in between.

Two tracks

- **Image-gen via v4 prompt** — mid- and higher-complexity scenes: marketing heroes, feature-page illustrations, blog headers, About imagery, onboarding scenes, social posts. Any 16:9 composition with a recognisable scene.
- **Hand-coded SVG** — basic, simple, direct primitives only: graph vocabulary (node, edge, cluster, trail, confidence, highlight), section dividers, in-product state dots, painterly-field backdrop.

Rule of thumb. If the piece fits in a 120×90 brand-guide vocabulary card, hand-SVG. If it wants to be a 16:9 scene, image-gen.

The universal prompt

A single subject-agnostic prompt template lives at [docs/illustration-prompt.md](#) (published at [/illustration-prompt.md](#)). Fill the **SUBJECT:** line with one sentence describing the scene; paste into Gemini / Adobe Firefly / Bing Image Creator / Imagen / Stable Diffusion. The prompt governs **how** the image is rendered — palette, composition, depth, shape vocabulary, figure treatment — not **what** appears in it. The same prompt produces a person at a desk, a city skyline, a data dashboard, or an abstract concept, all in the brand voice.

Style controls (hard rules)

- **No outlines.** Filled shapes only. No strokes, borders, or line art anywhere.
- **Tint discipline.** Supporting elements use 20–60% tints of the primary spectrum colours. Never default to pure neutrals — that leaves compositions drab and cold.
- **One hero primary per composition.** A single spectrum colour dominates; the others appear as supporting tints or small accents. Not all four primaries at full saturation.
- **Subtle depth.** On rounded organic objects, a single darker tonal step on the shadow side (one deeper value of the same fill colour). No soft gradients on objects, no drop shadows.
- **Both shape modes always present.** Geometric primitives (circles, rectangles, triangles, arcs, half-circles) and organic curved shapes (soft contours, flowing lines, blobs) both appear —

geometric content never below ~15% of the coloured area, even in nature / soft subjects, to keep compositions anchored.

- **Figures (when subject calls for them).** Clean silhouette, flat-block clothing in palette colours, simple hair, suggested face only (one dot per eye or blank). No detailed facial features.
- **Coloured ground.** Background is a palette neutral (Canvas #FDFDFB preferred, Paper #FAF8F2 when a slightly warmer ground is wanted) or a soft palette gradient. Not pure white, not pure grey.
- **Asymmetric balance.** Rule-of-thirds or diagonal flow. Never centred.

Warmth + palette checklist

Every generator output ships only if it hits all eight:

1. Zero outlines anywhere.
2. Every element carries colour — no element defaults to pure neutral fill.
3. One hero primary dominates; others as supporting tints / accents.
4. At least one rounded object has a single darker tonal step for depth.
5. Both geometric and organic modes present; geometric floor ~15%.
6. Coloured ground — palette neutral or gradient, not pure white / grey.
7. Face is a suggestion — one dot per eye max, or blank.
8. Asymmetric balance.

Reject conditions. Any outline, neutral grey backdrop, four-colour confetti (all primaries at full saturation), or detailed face — regenerate.

What the system never does

- Outlines, strokes, borders, line-art rendering
- Photorealism, 3D rendering, isometric projection, perspective
- Drop shadows, glows, lens flares
- Textures, noise, grain, hatching
- Off-brand colours (neon, magenta, cyan, bright yellow, pastel pink, purple, lavender, bright green)
- Mascot characters, anthropomorphic objects, cartoon faces
- Stock photography for warmth — use image-gen via the prompt

Versioning

v4 (2026-04-19) — universal subject-agnostic prompt for scenes, tight hand-SVG substrate for primitives only. Retires v3's two-style split (Editorial Geometry + Living Graph), the ten-noun recurring subject cast, the atoms/forms/treatments/palette four-layer vocabulary as a

generation constraint, the four-channel production matrix, the decision rubric, and the SpectreaFigure Bauhaus limbs-figure component. Full prompt and checklist at docs/illustration-prompt.md (published at [/illustration-prompt.md](#)).

10. Motion

Philosophy

Purposeful, subtle, natural — and alive. Every animation answers “what does this help the user understand?” — if the answer is “nothing,” remove it. Most interactive motion stays restrained (150–300ms hovers, focus, state changes). Three signature primitives below carry the brand’s “alive, growing, compounding” claim — used purposefully, not decoratively.

Durations

- 100 ms — micro (hover tints, colour shifts)
- 150 ms — standard (UI transitions, dropdowns)
- 200 ms — comfortable (modals, slide-overs)
- 300 ms — deliberate (page transitions, choreographed sequences)

Easing

- `ease-out ( cubic-bezier(0, 0, 0.2, 1) )` — default for things entering or settling.
- `ease-in-out ( cubic-bezier(0.4, 0, 0.2, 1) )` — for back-and-forth movements, continuous animations.
- Never use linear (feels mechanical) or ease-in alone (feels like something is wrong).

Signature motion primitives (three)

Three brand-distinctive motion patterns. Reusable across any Spectrea surface — used at meaningful moments, not decoratively. Each carries one part of the *alive, growing, compounding* brand claim.

1. Arrival (~400ms). When something important enters the frame — a new card, a fresh result, an inserted item. Spec: scale from 0 with soft elastic settle (`cubic-bezier(0.34, 1.56, 0.64, 1)`), then a brief radial pulse in a brand spectrum colour. Reads as “something just arrived and is alive.”

2. Formation (~300ms). When two things visibly connect — a line, a link, a relationship being shown. Spec: a curved stroke draws between two points with the spectrum gradient running along the line (`stroke-dashoffset` animation on an SVG path with a linear gradient stroke), then settles to its resting colour. Echoes the Bézier curve in the brand mark.

3. Spectrum sweep (~600ms). The brand's signature moment — used sparingly when something meaningful happens that deserves the brand's full voice. Spec: a thin gradient strip (4px tall, ~75% width of its container) traverses Cobalt → Teal → Amber → Rose with `background-position` animation across a 4× wide gradient, fading in at 15% and out at 85%. Spectrea's most distinctive motion. Reserve for moments that genuinely matter — overuse dilutes it.

Animated mark

The Spectrea mark animates on a 3-second loop: the spectrum stroke draws along the S curve, pauses, then dissolves to reveal the dots again. Always uses the **full spectrum** (Cobalt → Teal → Amber) — the "reveal" moment. Use for loading states, hero animations, and motion assets.

11. Components

Buttons

- **Primary (Cobalt)** — the hero action. One per section. `#4271DF`, white text; hover `#3A63C4`; active `#3255A7`.
- **Secondary** — supporting actions. Cloud (`#F4F4F1`) background, Ink text (light); Graphite tint background, Cloud text (dark).
- **Ghost** — tertiary actions. 2-px border, transparent background.
- **Destructive (Rose)** — irreversible actions. `#F24260`, white text.
- **Confirm (Teal)** — verify, approve, connect. `#00B6A0`, white text.
- **Caution (Amber)** — override, merge, proceed. `#E19000`, white text.

Common specs: padding `px-4 py-2` (default), radius `8 px` (rounded-lg), font `Lexend 500`, font-size `14 px`.

Focus ring: Amber, 2 px solid, 2 px offset (`.btn-focus:focus-visible`). Light surfaces use Amber active `#A86E00` (4.21:1 on Canvas, 3.89:1 on Cloud); dark surfaces use alpha-tinted Amber `rgba(225, 144, 0, 0.7)` (4.00:1 blended on Ink) — every pairing clears the 3:1 UI floor (ratified 2026-08-07; the previous universal soft ring measured 1.90:1/1.81:1 on light).

Forms

Input fields: `1 px` border (Tailwind `stone-200` ≈ Cloud-adjacent), `8 px` radius, `px-3 py-2` padding, `14 px` Lexend. On focus: `2 px` Cobalt border, no separate shadow ring. Placeholder colour: Pewter.

Cards

Container: 1 px border (Tailwind `stone-200`), 12 px radius (`rounded-xl`), 20 px padding (`p-5`), Canvas background. Elevated variant adds `shadow-md` (floating elements only). Cards sit on the Cloud surface — the Canvas-vs-Cloud contrast gives them "home."

Layout

- **Sidebar:** 256 px fixed width, collapsible on mobile.
- **Top bar:** 40–48 px height. Search + user menu.
- **Content area:** fluid, scrollable, Cloud (`#F4F4F1`) background.
- **Breakpoints:** mobile `<640 px` (1 column), tablet `640–1023` (2 cols), desktop `1024–1279` (3 cols), wide `1280+` (4 cols).
- **Base spacing unit:** 4 px. All spacing values are multiples of 4.

12. Communications

Voice in action

Every piece of written output — product copy, email, social, presentation slides — follows the same voice formula: clear, specific, warm. Technical language is welcomed when it earns its place ("graph architecture" is fine; "leveraging our graph-based RAG pipeline for vector embeddings" is not).

Email

- **Signature:** Logotype at `fontSize=11`, `colorMode="ink"`, `color="#212226"`, followed by "We connect the dots."
- **Transactional header:** LogotypeGradient at `fontSize=13` on Canvas.
- **Marketing header (dark):** LogotypeGradient at `fontSize=13` on Ink. No `wordmarkColor` override.
- **Body typography:** Lexend 400, 16 px, Ink on Canvas.

Social media

- **Avatar:** gradient mark at 400×400 px (square, no crop).
- **Cover images:** brand gradient bar + tagline on Ink background (LinkedIn); gradient bar at bottom with tagline centered (Twitter/X).
- **Bio template:** "We connect the dots. Composable intelligence platform."
- **Quote card:** Ink background, Cloud text, Mist (`#B0B0B6`) attribution, `h-1` brand gradient accent strip at bottom.

- **Stat card:** Ink background, 3 xl Cloud number, Mist (#B0B0B6) supporting text, gradient accent strip at bottom.

Presentations

Your deck lives on Canvas. The warmth is deliberate — it's what keeps a Spectrea talk from feeling like a system briefing. Ink slides earn their place as punctuation: a number that lands, a section break worth pausing on, the closing ask. Think four-fifths Canvas, one-fifth Ink.

- **Default slide background:** Canvas (#FDFDFB). Carries the everyday — opening, agenda, content, data, close — roughly 80%+ of any deck. Add a soft corner wisp of the brand gradient at ~8% opacity so the page breathes rather than sits flat.
- **Ink slide background:** Ink (#18181C). Reserved for section dividers, single-stat emphasis, closing CTA. Keep to $\leq 20\%$ of the deck; contrast works because it's earned, not because it's the default.
- **On Ink slides:** text is Cloud #F4F4F1 ; muted is Mist #B0B0B6 ; accents stay themselves. The wisp lifts to ~14% so the warmth still reads against the dark.
- **Title typography:** Albert Sans 600, 48 px.
- **Body typography:** Lexend 400, 24 px.
- **Accent strip:** brand gradient, 2–4 px tall, at the bottom of title, stat, and divider slides (Canvas or Ink). Leave it off content slides so it keeps its meaning.
- **Logotype, not just the mark, wherever the slide has room.** Centered LogotypeGradient on title and closing-CTA slides (the brand's signature hero treatment). Small Logotype footer at `fontSize=9` , bottom-left, on content, stat, and divider slides (`colorMode="ink"` on Canvas with `color="#97979E"` ; `colorMode="white"` on Ink with `color="#B0B0B6"`). The bare mark is for favicons and tight spaces — not deck hero moments.

Trust & disclosures (approved masters)

Brand-voice masters, not legal instruments — **review with counsel before external legal use.**

- **Privacy:** "Your knowledge belongs to you. Spectrea is private by default: what you add is visible only to you and the people you explicitly share it with, and the system enforces that per viewer on every surface — including the assistant, which sees only what you can see."
- **AI use:** "Spectrea uses AI to suggest, surface, and draft — and to run only the automations you set guardrails for: you decide what runs on its own and what checks with you first. Every AI action is recorded, attributed to its sources, and reviewable. On the managed path, your data is not used to train foundation models — a contract we are formalizing, with independent ISO 42001-class attestation as a stated target."
- **Retention:** "You stay in control of what Spectrea keeps. Your workspace persists until you delete it; deletion removes your data from live systems on a published schedule. And you can always leave with everything: full-fidelity export — structure, data, and provenance — is a first-class guarantee."

- **Enterprise readiness:** "Trust in Spectrea is architectural first: per-viewer access control, provenance, and privacy are properties of the substrate, not compliance features added afterwards. Data is sovereign — full-fidelity export is guaranteed, and the deployment perimeter widens by tier from managed cloud to single-tenant/VPC to air-gapped. Formal attestations (SOC 2, ISO 27001, ISO 42001-class AI governance) and uptime/incident commitments are staged targets, stated as such: the architecture is the foundation; the program is what makes it independently verifiable."

Executive voice

Founder and executive surfaces — bylines, talks, investor letters, interviews, personal social — use the same voice formula in the first person. Speak as a practitioner who builds and uses the product: concrete observations, shown work, named trade-offs. No corporate we-speak, no vision without evidence.

Right	Wrong
<i>"I kept watching decisions we'd already settled get re-argued three months later, because nobody could find why we'd decided. That's the problem Spectrea started from."</i>	<i>"We're thrilled to announce the next chapter in our journey to revolutionize how the world works with knowledge."</i>

The right version is a practitioner's observation — first person, specific, checkable. The wrong version is corporate we-speak built on a neverUse word. The brand's origin stance is **decided (Darren, 2026-07-03): codified silence** — the brand stays silent on origin — no origin claims, no locality framing ("engineered in Singapore" or similar), on any surface. Do not originate origin copy.

13. Governance

The simple test

If you need to ask "is this OK?" — it probably isn't. The logo should always look exactly like the approved versions on the Variations page. When in doubt, use the primary treatment (grey dots, Cool-Duet stroke) on Canvas — that's always correct.

Change process

1. **Propose** — document what you want to change and why.
2. **Review** — design lead + brand lead sign off.
3. **Version** — bump `meta.version` in `src/data/brand.ts` and the related code; this guide and derived artifacts follow.

4. **Communicate** — change log posted in `#brand` ; the durable changelog is the git history of the spectrea-branding repo.

Owner

Brand lead owns the brand system. "brand.ts is the canonical brand data. The app renders it; the guide (brand-guide.md), llms.txt, the PDF, and generated assets are derived mirrors. On any conflict, brand.ts wins. Claims are anchored to the ratified product vision (spectrea/docs/00-overview), not to shipped code; execution status lives in spectrea's roadmap — check it before placing a capability claim on a buyer-facing surface." (`meta.sourceOfTruth` , quoted verbatim.)

Brand decisions live in the **ratification ledger** (`ratificationLedger` in `brand.ts`): a decision recorded only in a consumer repo's AGENTS.md is not canon until it lands in the ledger.

14. Resources

CSS tokens

```
:root {
  /* Spectrum */
  --color-brand: #4271DF;
  --color-brand-teal: #00B6A0;
  --color-brand-amber: #E19000;
  --color-brand-rose: #F24260;

  /* Warm Blend neutrals — OKLCH-even seven-token ladder */
  --color-canvas: #FDFDFB;
  --color-cloud: #F4F4F1;
  --color-pewter: #97979E;
  --color-slate: #6D6D72;
  --color-iron: #46464B;
  --color-graphite: #212226;
  --color-ink: #18181C;

  /* Bridge washes (light) */
  --wash-cobalt: #EDF0F8;
  --wash-teal: #E6F5F3;
  --wash-amber: #F5F0E6;
  --wash-rose: #FDF0F2;

  /* Dark surfaces (parallel mode — role-inverted) */
  --dark-canvas: #18181C; /* page bg on dark */
  --dark-cloud: #212226; /* elevated on dark */
  --dark-ink: #F4F4F1; /* primary text on dark */
  --dark-mist: #B0B0B6; /* muted text on dark (new) */
  --dark-fog: #2E2F35; /* border / divider on dark (new) */
}
```

```

/* Dark bridge washes */
--dark-wash-cobalt: #1B2440;
--dark-wash-teal:    #0E2E2A;
--dark-wash-amber:   #2E2410;
--dark-wash-rose:    #2E1218;

/* Accent dark-lifts (long-form coloured text on dark only) */
--cobalt-lift: #7A9AEF;
--teal-lift:   #3DD3BF;
--amber-lift:  #F2AE40;
--rose-lift:   #F97587;

/* Typography */
--font-heading: 'Albert Sans', sans-serif;
--font-body:    'Lexend', 'Inter', sans-serif;
--font-mono:    'JetBrains Mono', monospace;

/* Radii – see Radii table below */
--radius-sm:    4px; /* tags, badges, inline code */
--radius-md:    6px; /* compact buttons, small controls */
--radius-lg:    8px; /* buttons, inputs, dropdowns */
--radius-xl:    12px; /* cards, panels, modals (default container) */
--radius-2xl:   16px; /* hero sections, large feature cards */
--radius-full:  9999px; /* avatars, spectrum tags, toggles */

/* Spacing – 4 px base unit, all values are multiples of 4 */
--space-2xs:    4px; /* p-1 – tight inline, icon gaps */
--space-xs:     8px; /* p-2 – input padding, badge padding, compact gaps */
--space-sm:     12px; /* p-3 – compact card padding, list item gaps */
--space-md:     16px; /* p-4 – default content gap, section padding */
--space-lg:     20px; /* p-5 – card padding (default), modal padding */
--space-xl:     24px; /* p-6 – section spacing, form field gaps */
--space-2xl:    32px; /* p-8 – major section breaks */
--space-3xl:    48px; /* p-12 – page top padding, hero spacing */
}

/* Brand gradient – OKLCH with sRGB fallback */
.brand-gradient {
  background: linear-gradient(135deg, #4271DF, #00B6A0, #E19000);
}
@supports (background: linear-gradient(in oklch, red, blue)) {
  .brand-gradient {
    background: linear-gradient(135deg in oklch, #4271DF, #00B6A0, #E19000);
  }
}

```

Radii

Six tokens. Container `xl` (12 px) is the default; buttons and inputs land on `lg` (8 px); everything else pegs to this scale.

Token	Value	Tailwind	Use
sm	4 px	<code>rounded</code>	Tags, badges, inline code
md	6 px	<code>rounded-md</code>	Compact buttons, small controls
lg	8 px	<code>rounded-lg</code>	Buttons, inputs, dropdowns
xl	12 px	<code>rounded-xl</code>	Cards, panels, modals (default container)
2xl	16 px	<code>rounded-2xl</code>	Hero sections, large feature cards
full	9999 px	<code>rounded-full</code>	Avatars, spectrum tags, toggles

Spacing

4 px base unit. Every spacing value is a multiple of 4 px. Fine inline elements (badges, compact controls) may use 2 px increments (6 px, 10 px); never arbitrary values like 5 px, 7 px, or 15 px.

Token	Value	Tailwind	Use
2xs	4 px	<code>p-1</code>	Tight inline, icon gaps
xs	8 px	<code>p-2</code>	Input / badge padding, compact gaps
sm	12 px	<code>p-3</code>	Compact card padding, list-item gaps
md	16 px	<code>p-4</code>	Default content gap, section padding
lg	20 px	<code>p-5</code>	Default card padding, modal padding
xl	24 px	<code>p-6</code>	Section spacing, form-field gaps
2xl	32 px	<code>p-8</code>	Major section breaks
3xl	48 px	<code>p-12</code>	Page top padding, hero spacing

Elevation

Six levels. Z-index increments by 10 to leave room for intermediate layers.

Level	z-index	Shadow	Use
Base	0	—	Page content, cards, sections
Raised	10	<code>shadow-sm</code>	Sticky headers, toolbars
Dropdown	20	<code>shadow-md</code>	Dropdowns, popovers, tooltips
Modal	30	<code>shadow-lg</code>	Modals, dialogs, slide-overs
Overlay	40	<code>shadow-xl</code>	Modal backdrops, full-screen overlays

Level	z-index	Shadow	Use
Toast	50	shadow-lg	Notifications, toasts

Icon library

Tabler Icons via `react-icons/tb` — outline and filled from one library. 2 px stroke, round caps/joins, 24×24 grid.

Fonts

All via Google Fonts:

- [Albert Sans](#) (weights 600, 700)
- [Lexend](#) (weights 300, 400, 500, 600)
- [JetBrains Mono](#) (weight 400)

`src/data/brand.ts` is the canonical brand data (v2.5.8, 2026-08-08). The live app at branding.spectrea.com renders it; this document, `llms.txt`, the PDF, and the generated assets are derived mirrors for offline and LLM-readable use. If surfaces ever disagree, `brand.ts` wins.